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Airbnb

Senior Software Engineer, Insurance Platform

Hi,

I'm applying for the Senior Software Engineer role on the Insurance Platform team. I've spent the last 6+ years building backend systems in Go and Java, and the work your team does on AirCover (travel insurance, host protection, liability, damage coverage) is the kind of problem I want to work on: high-stakes distributed systems where getting the details right matters.

At my current role, I'm the technical lead on a platform that processes 140M+ monthly invoicing transactions for Brazil's largest pharmaceutical retailer. I fixed a concurrency bug in our Apache Kafka pipeline that was causing fiscal compliance failures, added idempotency controls that brought reliability to 99.99%, and led a database migration from Oracle to PostgreSQL that cut our slowest queries by over a minute. I also set up the monitoring and logging stack we use to catch problems before they hit production.

Before that, I spent five years at Docile Alimentos where I led a monolith-to-microservices migration (Java/JSF to Spring Boot), cut MongoDB query times by 85%, and shipped 50+ features across Java and Go. I worked closely with product and design on engineering decisions, which I understand is important on the Insurance Platform team too.

On my own time, I contribute to the Zed code editor in Rust (70k+ GitHub stars). I have 19 merged PRs across 15+ subsystems, including fixing a deadlock in the rendering framework and reworking selection logic across 11 files. I also built Auto-Issue, a Go application with a work queue, concurrency limiter, and SSE streaming that turns GitHub issues into reviewed PRs.

The Insurance Platform role asks for experience with distributed systems, concurrency, SQL, monitoring, and cross-functional collaboration. That's what I do every day. I'd like to bring that experience to the AirCover program.

Best,

João Roberto Lawall Soares